

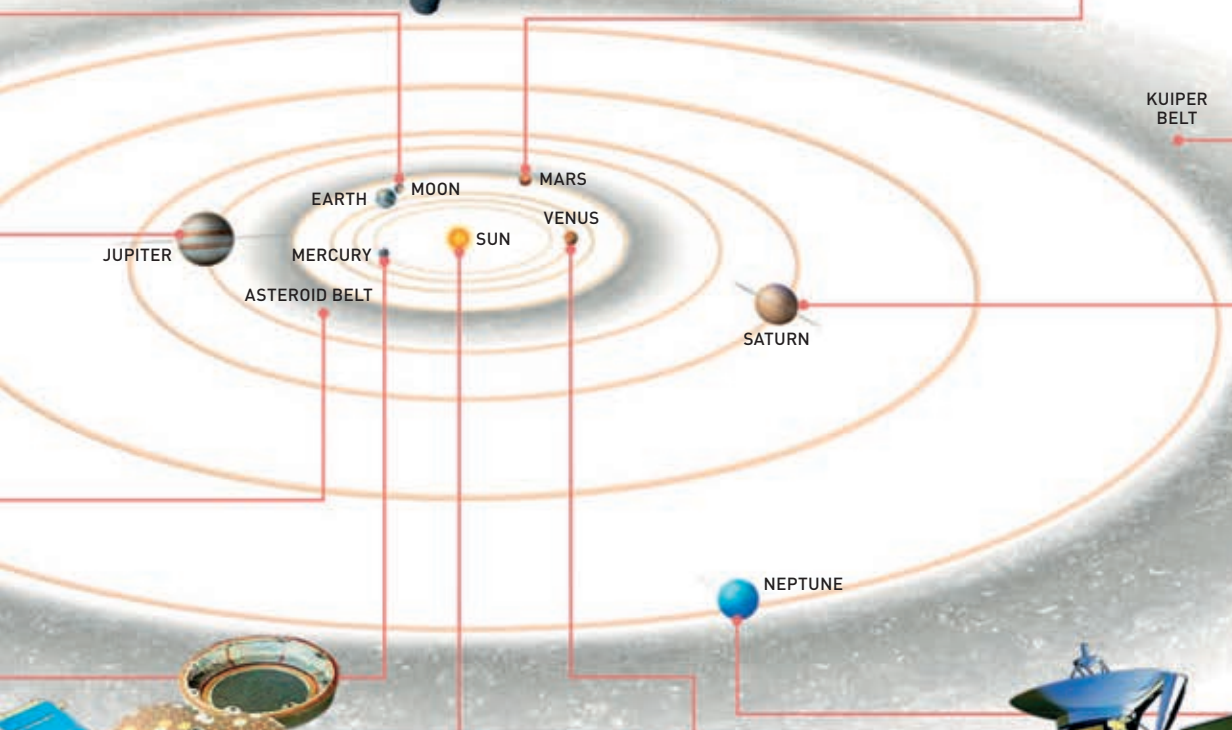


MISSIONS TO MARS

NUMBER OF MISSIONS SENT: 40+

KEY MISSIONS:

- **MARS GLOBAL SURVEYOR:** Launched in 1996, aiming to map the whole surface of Mars.
- **CURIOSITY:** An active mission, this landed on Mars in 2012 and has already discovered organic material.



MISSIONS TO KUIPER BELT

NUMBER OF MISSIONS SENT: 1

KEY MISSIONS:

- **NEW HORIZONS:** Launched in 2006 to take close-up pictures of the icy worlds in the Kuiper Belt, such as Pluto and its moons. By 2015 it had travelled 5 billion km (3 billion miles).

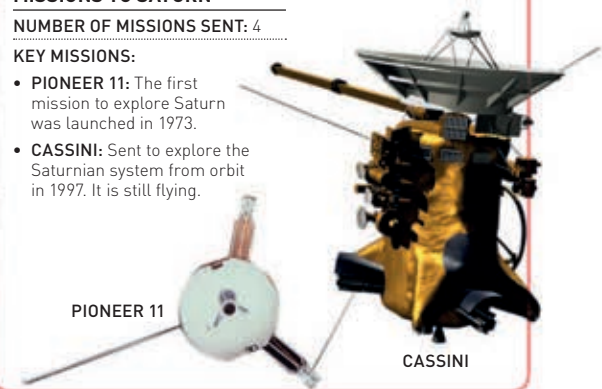


MISSIONS TO SATURN

NUMBER OF MISSIONS SENT: 4

KEY MISSIONS:

- **PIONEER 11:** The first mission to explore Saturn was launched in 1973.
- **CASSINI:** Sent to explore the Saturnian system from orbit in 1997. It is still flying.

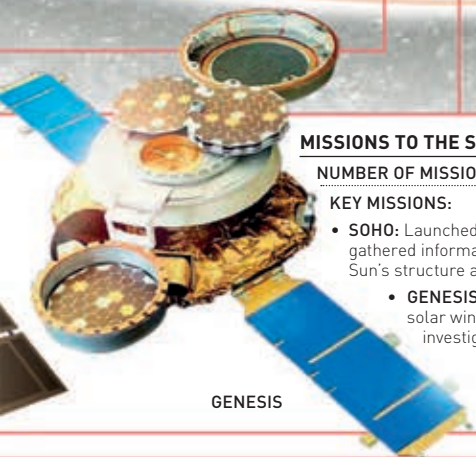


MISSIONS TO THE SUN

NUMBER OF MISSIONS SENT: 15

KEY MISSIONS:

- **SOHO:** Launched in 1995, this has gathered information about the Sun's structure and dynamics.
- **GENESIS:** Collected solar wind material for investigation in 2004.

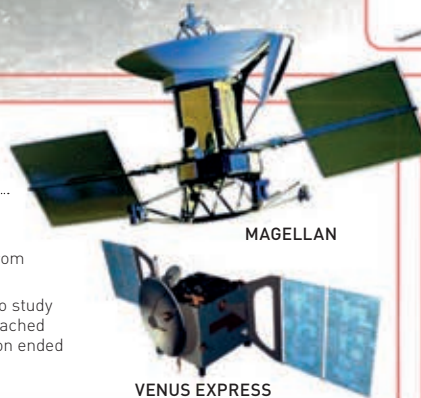


MISSIONS TO VENUS

NUMBER OF MISSIONS SENT: 40+

KEY MISSIONS:

- **MAGELLAN:** Sent on a radar mapping mission from 1989 to 1994.
- **VENUS EXPRESS:** Sent to study Venus's atmosphere, it reached Venus in 2006. The mission ended in 2014.

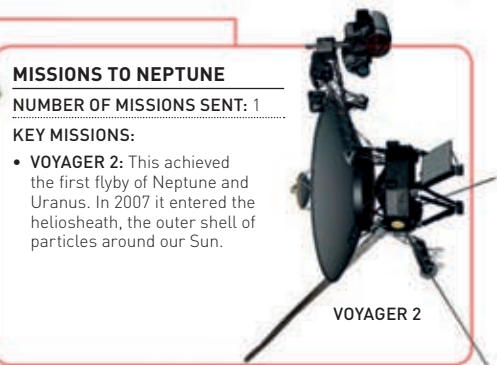


MISSIONS TO NEPTUNE

NUMBER OF MISSIONS SENT: 1

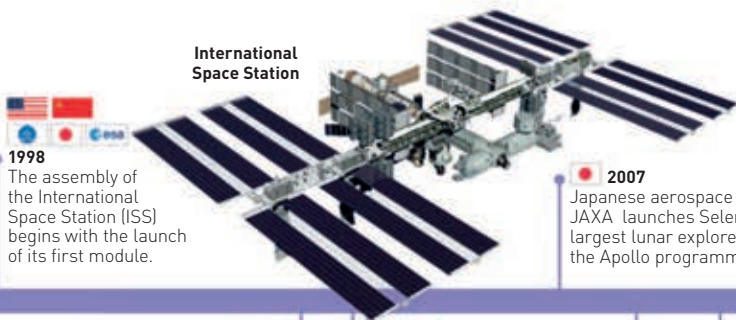
KEY MISSIONS:

- **VOYAGER 2:** This achieved the first flyby of Neptune and Uranus. In 2007 it entered the heliosheath, the outer shell of particles around our Sun.



1986
Mir, the first modular space station, is launched by the USSR.

1995
NASA's Galileo spacecraft becomes the first to orbit Jupiter. It studies the composition of the planet's atmosphere.



1998
The assembly of the International Space Station (ISS) begins with the launch of its first module.

2011
Tiangong-1, China's first space station, is launched.

2012
Dragon, the first commercial craft, carries cargo to and from the ISS.

2014
The European Philae probe is the first man-made object to land on a comet.



1990
NASA launches the Hubble Space Telescope into Earth's orbit using a space shuttle.

2003
The European Space Agency (ESA) launches Mars Express – its first visit to another planet in the Solar System.

2005
The European Huygens probe of the Cassini-Huygens mission lands on Saturn's moon, Titan. It is the first landing on another planet's moon.

2005
NASA launches the Mars Reconnaissance Orbiter (MRO) with scientific instruments on board.

2008
The Indian Space Research Organisation (ISRO) sends its first mission – Chandrayaan-1 – to the Moon.



2010
Virgin Galactic, a private company, flies the first suborbital plane.



Virgin Galactic

2015
NASA's Dawn mission orbits dwarf planet Ceres to take images.



Dawn